

# Cirque Corporation

## Change Management Policy

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### 1. Purpose

This Change Management Policy establishes the framework for managing changes to Cirque Corporation's information technology infrastructure, applications, and systems in a controlled and systematic manner.

The policy ensures that:

- All changes are properly evaluated for risk and impact
- Changes are tested and approved before implementation
- Changes are documented and communicated to stakeholders
- Changes can be rolled back if necessary
- Service continuity is maintained during change implementation

### 2. Scope

This policy applies to all changes affecting:

- Production systems and infrastructure
- Business-critical applications and software
- Security systems and controls
- Network infrastructure and configurations
- Cloud services and platforms

- Database systems and data structures
- IT service management tools
- User access and permissions systems

This policy covers all personnel including:

- IT staff and system administrators
- Software developers and engineers
- Third-party vendors and contractors
- Management and executives
- Any personnel requesting or implementing changes

### **3. Roles and Responsibilities**

Chief Information Security Officer (CISO):

- Overall accountability for change management policy
- Approval of high-risk and emergency changes
- Review of change management effectiveness

Head of IT:

- Responsible for ensuring changes are made appropriately
- Oversight of change management process
- Final approval authority for standard changes
- Coordination of Change Advisory Board (CAB)

Change Manager:

- Administration of change management system
- Scheduling and coordination of changes
- Facilitation of CAB meetings
- Reporting on change success rates and issues

Change Advisory Board (CAB):

- Review and approval of significant changes
- Assessment of change impacts and risks
- Coordination of change schedules

- Resolution of change conflicts

Change Requesters:

- Submission of accurate change requests
- Provision of complete technical documentation
- Coordination with affected teams
- Communication of change outcomes

Change Implementers:

- Execution of approved changes according to plan
- Documentation of implementation steps
- Testing and verification of changes
- Rollback execution if required

## **4. Change Categories**

Standard Changes:

- Pre-approved, low-risk, routine changes
- Follow established procedures and documentation
- Examples: password resets, user provisioning, routine patches
- No CAB approval required
- Documented in ticketing system

Normal Changes:

- Changes requiring assessment and approval
- May impact multiple systems or users
- Require testing and rollback plans
- CAB approval required for significant changes
- Examples: application updates, infrastructure modifications, security changes

Emergency Changes:

- Changes required to resolve critical incidents
- Expedited approval process
- CISO or designated authority approval required

- Post-implementation review mandatory
- Examples: security patches for active exploits, critical system failures

Major Changes:

- High-risk changes with significant business impact
- Extended planning and testing period
- Multiple stakeholder approvals required
- Executive management notification
- Examples: data center migrations, major system replacements

## **5. Change Request Process**

All changes must follow this process:

### **1. Change Initiation:**

- Submit change request in approved ticketing system
- Include detailed description and justification
- Specify affected systems and components
- Identify business impact and urgency

### **2. Change Assessment:**

- Technical feasibility review
- Risk and impact analysis
- Resource and scheduling evaluation
- Security impact assessment
- Compliance verification

### **3. Change Approval:**

- Standard changes: Automatic approval
- Normal changes: Change Manager or CAB approval
- Major changes: CAB and executive approval
- Emergency changes: CISO or delegate approval

### **4. Change Planning:**

- Development of implementation plan
- Creation of rollback procedures
- Identification of testing requirements
- Communication plan to stakeholders
- Scheduling of maintenance window

#### 5. Change Implementation:

- Execution according to approved plan
- Real-time monitoring of systems
- Documentation of all actions taken
- Immediate notification of issues

#### 6. Change Verification:

- Testing of implemented changes
- Validation of expected outcomes
- Confirmation of rollback capability
- Performance monitoring

#### 7. Change Closure:

- Documentation of results
- Closure in ticketing system
- Communication to stakeholders
- Lessons learned capture

## **6. Change Documentation Requirements**

All change requests must include:

- Detailed description of the change
- Business justification and benefits
- List of affected systems and components
- Technical implementation steps
- Testing and validation procedures
- Rollback plan and procedures

- Risk assessment and mitigation strategies
- Required resources and personnel
- Estimated duration and maintenance window
- Communication plan and stakeholders
- Pre-change and post-change validation criteria
- Dependencies on other systems or changes

Documentation must be maintained in the centralized change management system and retained for a minimum of three years.

## **7. Testing Requirements**

All changes must be tested before production implementation:

Development Environment Testing:

- Initial development and unit testing
- Code review and security analysis
- Documentation of test results

Non-Production Environment Testing:

- Testing in environment mirroring production
- Integration testing with dependent systems
- Performance and load testing
- Security and vulnerability testing
- User acceptance testing when applicable

Production Validation:

- Smoke testing immediately after implementation
- Functionality verification
- Performance baseline comparison
- Monitoring of system logs and alerts
- User confirmation of successful change

Emergency changes may have abbreviated testing with mandatory post-implementation validation.

## **8. Change Advisory Board (CAB)**

The CAB provides oversight and governance for significant changes:

CAB Membership:

- Head of IT (Chair)
- Change Manager
- Security representatives
- Network and infrastructure representatives
- Application development representatives
- Business stakeholders as needed

CAB Meetings:

- Regular meetings held weekly or as needed
- Emergency CAB meetings for urgent changes
- Quorum requirements for decision-making
- Documentation of all decisions and rationale

CAB Responsibilities:

- Review and approve normal and major changes
- Assess change risk and impact
- Coordinate change schedules to minimize conflicts
- Monitor change success rates and trends
- Recommend process improvements
- Escalate high-risk changes to executive management

## **9. Emergency Change Process**

Emergency changes address critical situations requiring immediate action:

Authorization:

- CISO or designated on-call authority must approve
- Verbal approval acceptable with documentation within 2 hours
- Business justification of emergency status required

Implementation:

- Follow abbreviated but documented process
- Implement minimum necessary changes
- Continuous monitoring during implementation
- Communication to relevant stakeholders

Post-Implementation:

- Full documentation within 24 hours
- Post-implementation review within 5 business days
- CAB retrospective of emergency change
- Permanent solution planned if temporary fix applied
- Update of emergency procedures if needed

## **10. Separation of Duties**

Change management maintains separation of duties:

Development and Production:

- Developers do not have production access
- Code promotion requires approval process
- Automated deployment tools used when possible
- Production changes logged and auditable

Change Request and Approval:

- Requesters cannot approve their own changes
- Independent review required for changes
- CAB provides independent oversight
- Audit trail maintained for all approvals

Implementation and Verification:

- Different personnel verify changes when possible
- Independent testing team for major changes
- Automated monitoring for change verification
- Management review of high-risk changes



## **11. Rollback Procedures**

All changes must include documented rollback procedures:

Rollback Requirements:

- Step-by-step rollback instructions
- Rollback decision criteria and thresholds
- Data backup and recovery procedures
- Rollback authorization process
- Estimated rollback duration

Rollback Execution:

- Immediate rollback if critical systems impacted
- Change Manager or CISO authorization for rollback
- Communication of rollback to stakeholders
- Documentation of rollback actions
- Root cause analysis of rollback necessity

Post-Rollback:

- System validation after rollback
- Incident documentation
- Corrective action planning
- Re-planning of change if still required

## **12. Change Communication**

Effective communication is essential for successful changes:

Before Implementation:

- Notification to affected users and stakeholders
- Maintenance window announcements
- Expected downtime or service impacts
- Contact information for questions or issues

During Implementation:

- Status updates at key milestones
- Immediate notification of issues or delays
- Extended downtime notifications
- Availability of support resources

After Implementation:

- Confirmation of successful completion
- Summary of changes made
- Known issues or limitations
- Instructions for reporting problems
- Thank you to affected users for patience

### **13. Change Performance Monitoring**

The organization monitors change management effectiveness:

Metrics Tracked:

- Number of changes by category
- Change success rate
- Number of failed changes
- Number of changes requiring rollback
- Emergency change frequency
- Average time to implement changes
- Number of unauthorized changes detected
- Compliance with change procedures

Regular Reviews:

- Monthly reporting on change metrics
- Quarterly CAB effectiveness review
- Annual policy review and update
- Trend analysis and process improvements
- Lessons learned from failed changes

Management receives monthly reports on change performance and any significant issues or trends.

## **14. Technology Acquisition and Development**

All technology acquisition, development, and maintenance is governed by change management:

New Technology Acquisition:

- Must follow change request process
- Security and compliance review required
- Integration impact assessment
- Budget and resource approval
- Vendor risk assessment for third-party products

Software Development:

- Development follows change management procedures
- Code changes tracked in version control
- Peer review and security analysis required
- Promotion through environments controlled
- Production deployment as approved change

System Maintenance:

- Scheduled maintenance as standard changes
- Patch management integrated with change process
- End-of-life system replacements planned as major changes
- Continuous monitoring and optimization

## **15. Policy Review and Updates**

This policy is reviewed at least annually:

Annual Review:

- Conducted by Head of IT and CISO
- Assessment of policy effectiveness
- Review of change success metrics
- Evaluation against industry best practices
- Update of procedures and requirements as needed

Policy Distribution:

- Updated policy distributed to all IT staff
- Training provided on significant changes
- Management briefing on policy updates
- Policy available in centralized document repository
- Acknowledgment of receipt tracked

Ad-hoc Reviews:

- Reviews triggered by significant incidents
- Reviews triggered by compliance requirements
- Reviews requested by audit findings
- Reviews for organizational changes

## **16. Compliance and Enforcement**

Compliance with this policy is mandatory:

Monitoring:

- Regular audits of change records
- Automated detection of unauthorized changes
- Review of change approval documentation
- Verification of testing and rollback procedures

Violations:

- Unauthorized changes constitute policy violation
- Bypassing approval process not permitted
- Disciplinary action for policy violations
- Possible termination for serious violations

Exceptions:

- Rare exceptions only with CISO approval
- Emergency situations with retroactive documentation
- Documented business justification required
- Exception review and closure mandatory